Lesson 12

THE ATTRIBUTES OF GOD

Aim: To study the attributes of God.

Introduction: Although we cannot totally comprehend all about God, we can know some of His attributes as implied and stated in the Bible.

"I can see how it might be possible for a man to look down upon the earth and be an atheist, but I cannot conceive how he could look up into the heavens and say there is no God."

- Abraham Lincoln

"Only God can fully satisfy the hungry heart of man." - Hugh Black

What is an attribute? :a usually good quality or feature that someone or something has

I. THE NATURAL ATTRIBUTES OF GOD.

<u>God is Spirit</u>. John 4:24, Luke 24:38-39

24“God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in the Spirit and in truth."

38 *He said to them, “Why are you troubled, and why do doubts rise in your*

minds? ***39*** *Look at my hands and my feet. It is I myself! Touch me and see; a ghost does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have.”*

<u>God is One</u>. Deuteronomy 4:35,39, Deuteronomy 6:4

35” You were shown these things so that you might know that the Lord is God; besides him there is no other.39 Acknowledge and take to heart this day that the Lord is God in heaven above and on the earth below. There is no other.”

4 “*Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is one.”*

God is Eternal. Psalms 93:2

"Your throne, O Lord, has stood from time immemorial. You yourself are from the everlasting past."

God is Immutable. Malachi 3:6

"I am the Lord, and I do not change. That is why you descendants of Jacob are not already destroyed.

II. THE ACTIVE ATTRIBUTES OF GOD.

God is Omnipotent - God is All Powerful. Gen. 18:14, Gen. 17:1

" Is anything too hard for the Lord? I will return to you at the appointed time next year, and Sarah will have a son.

When Abram was ninety-nine years old, the Lord appeared to him and said, "I am God Almighty[a]; walk before me faithfully and be blameless.

God is Omnipresent - God is present Everywhere. Jeremiah 23:23,24, Psalm 139:7-10 *23 "Am I only a God nearby," declares the Lord, "and not a God far away? 24 Who can*

hide in secret places so that I cannot see them?" declares the Lord. "Do not I fill heaven and earth?" declares the Lord.

<u>God is Omniscient - God knows all things.</u> Matthew 10:29,30

29 Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground outside your Father's care.[a] 30 And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered.

<u>God is Wise.</u> Psalm 104:24, James 1:5

24How many are your works, Lord! In wisdom you made them all; the earth is full of your creatures.

5 " If any of you lacks wisdom, you should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to you.

<u>God is Sovereign - Supreme power.</u> Matthew 20:15, Romans 9:21

15 Don't I have the right to do what I want with my own money? Or are you envious because I am generous?'

21 Does not the potter have the right to make out of the same lump of clay some pottery for special purposes and some for common use?

III. THE MORAL ATTRIBUTES OF GOD.

God is Holy. Absolute Moral purity. Isaiah 57:15, 1 Peter 1:15,16

15 For this is what the high and exalted One says— he who lives forever, whose name is holy: "I live in a high and holy place, but also with the one who is contrite and lowly in spirit, to revive the spirit of the lowly and to revive the heart of the contrite.

15 But just as he who called you is holy, so be holy in all you do; 16 for it is written: "Be holy, because I am holy."

God is Righteous. Isaiah 11:3,4

3 and he will delight in the fear of the Lord. He will not judge by what he sees with his eyes, or decide by what he hears with his ears; 4 but with righteousness he will judge the needy, with

justice he will give decisions for the poor of the earth. He will strike the earth with the rod of his mouth; with the breath of his lips he will slay the wicked.

God is Faithful. Numbers 23:19, Heb.10:23

19 God is not human, that he should lie, not a human being, that he should change his mind. Does he speak and then not act? Does he promise and not fulfill?

23 Let us hold unswervingly to the hope we profess, for he who promised is faithful.

God is Merciful. Jeremiah 3:12

12 Go, proclaim this message toward the north: "'Return, faithless Israel,' declares the Lord, 'I will frown on you no longer, for I am faithful,' declares the Lord, 'I will not be angry forever.

God is Love. 1John 4:8-11

8 Whoever does not love does not know God, because God is love. 9 This is how God showed his love among us: He sent his one and only Son into the world that we might live through

him. 10 This is love: not that we loved God, but that he loved us and sent his Son as an atoning sacrifice for our sins. 11 Dear friends, since God so loved us, we also ought to love one another.

God is Good - The goodness of God is that attribute by reason of which He imparts life and other blessings to His creatures. - 1 Chronicles 16:34, Ezra 3:11, Psalms 25:8, Psalms 23:6

1 Chron 16:34 "Give thanks to the LORD, for he is good; his love endures forever."

Ezra 3:11" With praise and thanksgiving they sang to the LORD:"He is good; his love toward Israel endures forever."

*Psalms 25:8 "*Good and upright is the LORD; therefore he instructs sinners in his ways.

Psalms 23: 6" Surely your goodness and love will follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

CONCLUSION

It is truly a privilege to know and serve the God of the Bible. Our response as believers, therefore, should be of total confidence and yieldedness.